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Revision Date:
10/01/2025

Background:
CalFresh households (HHs) that meet specific eligibility criteria may use their CalFresh benefits to purchase prepared meals from providers approved by Food and Nutrition Services (FNS).

Purpose:
The section has been updated due to sunset review. This section has been renamed to incorporate CalFresh benefit usage at communal dining facilities and authorized homeless meal providers for eligible CalFresh HHs. There are no changes to the policy.

Policy:
Eligible HHs may use their CalFresh benefits for home-delivered meals, at communal dining facilities, or with other authorized homeless meal providers.

Home-Delivered Meals
To qualify for home-delivered meals, the CalFresh recipient must not reside in a boarding house or institution and meet the following:

- Be 60 years or older; and unable to leave their home due to a disability, medical condition, or have limited mobility that prevents them preparing their own meals.
- Be the spouse living with an individual who meets one of the above criteria.

Home-delivered meals must be provided through non-profit meal delivery service programs that are approved by FNS to accept CalFresh benefits.

Communal Dining Facilities
CalFresh recipients who are 60 or older, or who receive Supplemental Security Income (SSI), and their spouses, may use their CalFresh benefits to purchase meals from approved communal dining facilities.

Authorized Homeless Meal Providers
CalFresh recipients who are experiencing homelessness may use their CalFresh benefits to purchase prepared meals from FNS authorized homeless meal providers.

For a list of approved home-delivered meal providers, communal dining meal facilities, or homeless meal providers, HHs may contact:

- Aging & Independence Services (AIS) Call Center: (800) 339-4661.
- 2-1-1 San Diego.

References:
Manual of Policies and Procedures (MPP) 63-604.2.
Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) 274.7(g)(1).
All County Letter (ACL) 19-51.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by 09/30/2028.

Approval for Release:

10-1-25

Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services